forming a tail of hot gas that the hole then sucked back inward to form an accretion disk.

Figure 16.4 shows a computer simulation of the last few milliseconds of the star's life. At ten milliseconds before the end, the black hole is spinning around the red-arrowed axis, and the star is orbiting around the picture's vertical axis. At four milliseconds the hole's tendex lines are stretching the star apart. At two milliseconds, the hole's whirling space has thrown the stellar debris up into the hole's equatorial plane. At zero milliseconds, the debris is beginning to form an accretion disk.



Fig. 16.3. Gravitational waves flowing out from the orbiting star and hole, as seen from the bulk. *[Drawing by LIGO Laboratory artist based on my hand sketch.]*